

Start here when you don't know which card to pull. Read from the top and take the first row that matches. Several at once? Safety comes first.

1 I'm afraid, being threatened, or not free to say no

This includes jealousy that leads to checking, restricting, or accusing.

 **Stop.** These tools are not for this. Get outside help (see Help Lines, on the back). Immediate danger: your local emergency number (999 UK/SG · 911 US · 000 AU · 112 EU).

2 I'm flooded or shut down (but safe)
Racing heart, tunnel vision, urge to flee or win

 **Pause + Return** ·  **60-Second Alliance Reset** — Exact return time. For flooding, never for fear.

3 Outside pressure or disapproval from family, friends or strangers

 **Unity Anchor** — Decide together how the couple responds; never limit a partner's contact with anyone. Pressure from your partner? Green Rule, or row 1.

4 Trust breach
Lying, infidelity, a broken agreement

 **Trust Recovery** (+  **Proof Protocol**) — Safety first. Agree one change you'll both see, and when to check it.

5 Pulling away / uninvestment
Warmth missing, repairs on autopilot

 **Uninvestment Check** (+  **Full Recovery**) — No signs: keep up the daily floor. One or two: you likely need space and small repairs. Three or more: book a Full Recovery within a week. Contempt, fear or coercion: stop and get outside support first.

6 A fight is starting
Voices rising; you're both building a case

 **System Overlay** ·  **Conflict Protocol** — Green Rule first. Flooded midway → Pause + Return.

7 After a fight, or something small stung

 **Micro-Repair** — Start within minutes if you can; complete within 24 hours. If it was bigger: Full Recovery. If something needs to change: Proof Protocol.

8 We keep clashing the same way
Reach-Recoil (one reaches, the other pulls back), Repeat Ask (the same ask, on repeat), Pace Mismatch (one ready to talk sooner)

 **Circuit Library** /  **Drift Check** (+  **Profile Calibration**) — Name the loop out loud, then find it in the Circuit Library (Manual Appendix A). Clashing on timing? Manual Ch X.

9 Intimacy feels stuck

 **Intimacy Pact** — Pacts Worksheet. Pressure after a no → Green Rule talk; again, or can't say no → Help Lines.

10 Saying one thing, doing another
Your own follow-through

 **Consistency Pact** (+  **Proof Protocol**) — Private weekly check. After a breach, add a shared Proof item.

11 We feel like housemates
Logistics only; the connection feels thin

 **Morning + Evening Rhythm** — Feels like a chore? Take a night off fixing (a Sun Memory); see the Sensory Comfort Inventory. Two weeks flat? Try the Drift Check.

12 Time for our weekly check-in

 **Weekly Reset** — About 40 minutes, on a timer; Weekly Reset Agenda; the monthly Care Check-in (inside the Weekly Reset).

 **At any point, if someone floods:** take a Pause + Return, then restart warm. If threats, fear, coercion or violence appear, do not return at the set time: leave safely and use the Help Lines.

Icons match the card corners. Back: Quick Reference + Help Lines.

 **Afraid of your partner, being threatened, or not free to say no?** (This includes jealousy that leads to checking, restricting, or accusing.) Stop. These tools are not for this. Get outside help: Help Lines below.

THE THREE TO REACH FOR FIRST (ALL CORE)

 **Green Rule (Safety Gate) · CORE**
The one rule that can't be broken: the honest thing must be safe to say. Pause the topic; if flooded but safe, take a Pause + Return.

"This doesn't feel safe right now."

 **Pause + Return · CORE**
Time apart, with an exact time to come back. For flooding, never for fear. 20 minutes minimum, 24 hours max.

"I need a pause. I'll be ready at ____."

 **60-Second Alliance Reset · CORE**
Still in the room and it's turning into a fight to win? Stop · say it · touch (only if welcome) · three slow breaths · an exact time to keep talking.

"I want to connect, not fight."

When to use which

 Flooded; need to leave and come back	→ Pause + Return
 Still in the room, tone rising, both willing to stop for a minute	→ 60-Second Alliance Reset
 Outside pressure or disapproval from family, friends or strangers	→ Unity Anchor
 Trust breach	→ Trust Recovery + Proof Protocol
 Pulling away	→ Uninvestment Check
 About to say or hear something hard	→ Green Rule (Safety Gate)
 Small sting or sharp tone	→ Micro-Repair
 Anything else	→ the Situation Map (front)

 **If someone floods:** take a Pause + Return, then restart warm. If threats, fear, coercion or violence appear, do not return at the set time: leave safely and use the Help Lines.

HELP LINES

Immediate danger: your local emergency number (999 UK/SG · 911 US · 000 AU · 112 EU)

US: National Domestic Violence Hotline 1-800-799-7233 (text START to 88788) · 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline (call/text 988)

UK: National Domestic Abuse Helpline (Refuge) 0808 2000 247 · Samaritans 116 123

Australia: 1800RESPECT 1800 737 732 · Lifeline 13 11 14

Singapore: National Anti-Violence & Sexual Harassment Helpline 1800 777 0000 · SOS 1767

LGBTQ+-affirming: US: Trevor Project 1-866-488-7386 (under 25) · LGBT National Hotline 1-888-843-4564 · UK: Switchboard LGBT+ 0800 0119 100 · Australia: QLife 1800 184 527 · Singapore: Oogachaga (oogachaga.com)

Elsewhere: your local emergency number or national helpline.

More Help Lines: allianceprotocols.com/help